Project Report Format

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer is a ServiceNow workflow automation project for standard laptop procurement. The solution connects the Standard Laptop Service Catalog request with approval and automatic Catalog Task creation so that the Hardware team can configure the laptop promptly.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose is to reduce manual intervention, avoid delays after approval, improve task allocation, and provide a more consistent procurement and configuration process.

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Problem Statement

Standard laptop requests require configuration after procurement, but manual handling can lead to oversight, delays, user waiting time, and inefficient IT resource allocation.

2.2 Empathy Map Canvas

The primary user perspective is that of an IT procurement team member who needs standard laptop requests to move smoothly from request and approval to hardware configuration. The expected outcome is timely configuration with less manual follow-up.

2.3 Brainstorming

The selected solution is to automate task creation after approval using ServiceNow Flow Designer, assign the generated task to the Hardware group, and make the required laptop configuration information available in the task.

3. REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS

3.1 Customer Journey map

The workflow journey is: user selects Standard Laptop → places the request → request enters approval → approval is granted → Flow Designer creates the Catalog Task → task is assigned to Hardware → Hardware configures the laptop → task/request status can be verified.

3.2 Solution Requirement

Functional requirements include Standard Laptop ordering, approval handling, automatic Catalog Task creation, short description and description updates, Hardware assignment, and approval-state handling. Non-functional goals include reduced manual effort, timely processing, consistency, and improved operational efficiency.

3.3 Data Flow Diagram

The logical data flow is from the Service Catalog request to the Requested Item and approval record, then through Flow Designer to a Catalog Task assigned to Hardware. The task status and details are available from the Requested Item record.

3.4 Technology Stack

The solution uses ServiceNow Service Catalog and Flow Designer. The flow is named 'Standard laptop task', uses a Service Catalog trigger, runs as the System user, and uses the Create Catalog Task action. No separate frontend, backend server, MongoDB database, or custom API is used.

4. PROJECT DESIGN

4.1 Problem Solution Fit

The solution directly addresses the identified problem by automatically creating the hardware configuration task after approval, reducing manual intervention and helping ensure that the laptop is ready for configuration when it arrives.

4.2 Proposed Solution

Create and activate a Flow Designer flow that triggers from the Service Catalog, creates a Catalog Task for the Requested Item, sets the required laptop configuration description, assigns the Hardware group, and records the approved state.

4.3 Solution Architecture

The architecture is ServiceNow-native: Service Catalog → Request/Requested Item → Approval → Flow Designer → Create Catalog Task → Hardware assignment → Catalog Task status/verification. The Standard Laptop catalog item is connected to the flow through its Process Engine configuration.

5. PROJECT PLANNING & SCHEDULING

5.1 Project Planning

The project activities are organized around flow creation, flow assignment to the Standard Laptop catalog item, service request and approval validation, and verification of the resulting Catalog Task. Exact team names and calendar dates were not specified in the provided project materials.

6. FUNCTIONAL AND PERFORMANCE TESTING

6.1 Performance Testing

The supplied project evidence supports functional workflow validation rather than measured load or benchmark testing. The main test path is to place a Standard Laptop request, approve it, open the Requested Item, and verify that the Catalog Task contains the expected short description and Hardware assignment.

7. RESULTS

7.1 Output Screenshots

The project workflow produces a ServiceNow Standard Laptop request, an approval record, and a generated Catalog Task. The final task can be opened from the Requested Item to verify the updated short description and assigned group. No external demo link was specified.

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES

Advantages: reduces manual intervention; improves task allocation; supports timely laptop configuration; provides a repeatable approval-to-task workflow; improves visibility of the generated Catalog Task.

Disadvantages: depends on correct ServiceNow configuration and activation of the flow; depends on the Standard Laptop catalog item and approval state; the supplied project does not document advanced exception handling or performance benchmarks.

9. CONCLUSION

The ServiceNow Flow Designer solution streamlines standard laptop procurement by connecting approval with automatic Catalog Task creation and Hardware assignment. This reduces manual overhead, supports faster configuration, and improves the overall procurement workflow.

10. FUTURE SCOPE

Future enhancements can include notifications, SLA tracking, exception handling, additional laptop models, richer procurement reporting, monitoring dashboards, and broader automation for other hardware requests.

11. APPENDIX

Source Code (if any)

Not applicable; the project is implemented as ServiceNow configuration and Flow Designer automation.

Dataset Link

Not applicable; no external dataset is used.

GitHub & Project Demo Link

Not specified in the provided project materials.